

Discipline Yourself So No One Else Has To: Pat in Her Own Words

Coach Pat Summitt

It's very important in athletics and particularly with our teams here at the University of Tennessee is that we have great work ethic. And the amazing thing is, some of the most talented players are not always the ones that work the hardest. Go figure that out. Why? Because they don't have it right here. You've got to have it in your heart. You've got to be invested. And it's not just in what you do as you work hard, but when you're building a big team concept, I mean, you've got to go get other people and you've got to bring them in and say, "You're not working as hard as you can work. And what does that do to our team?"

But it starts with the individual -- just knowing that if they invest every day, when it's game time, things are going to fall in place; because you're going to make them happen because of the habits that you have. And then for me, as a coach, I'm going to bring the whole team together and I'm going to say, "If you don't work hard, you don't need to be at the University of Tennessee; because what you're doing is taking away from the team concept and you've got to be invested in our team concept and everyone has to work hard every day."